

forward passionately, persistently and powerfully with a will and vision. There may be some omissions like Kiran Mazumdar Shaw. And I wonder how a controversial figure like Salman Rushdie emerges as a powerful overseas Indian?

A. JACOB SAHAYAM,
Thiruvananthapuram

Among the high and mighty, Lalit Modi should have been right at the top. The monster he has unleashed in the form of Indian Premier League is awesome. Nobody can deny the fact that the man has nurtured his dream into a reality. India needs a few more Lalit Modis rather than Suresh Kalmadis in our sports administration.

COL (RETD) MNS THAMPI,
Thiruvananthapuram

Between the Lines

Your article on H.K. Lall who teaches at S.D. College in Chandigarh made for a good reading ("Couplet Reader", March 22). Lall's story would inspire other retired citizens to follow the enthusiastic teacher who remains steadfast in his mission to teach Urdu and the marvellous couplets without professional motives. That he has taught people of high calibre for an insignificant remuneration sounds strange. Also, his philosophy of "no work,

no mistake" while in service makes sense.

K.S. THAMPI, Chennai

Terror Games

It is time for the West Bengal Government and police to gear up its resources and plug the loopholes to prevent possible terror attacks, including kidnapping of the industrialists as well as other prominent people

was balanced ("Sniping Superstars", March 15). The true strength of the industry lies not in a Mammootty or a Mohanlal, but in the calibre of arguably the greatest group of supporting thespians in regional cinema. It's a shame that the Association of Malayalam Movie Artists has not lived up to its name to show some understanding



SUBIR HALDER/www.indiatodayimages.com

“The strangulating hold the bureaucrats have over well-meaning sportspersons is dangerous. They are perhaps unmindful of the damage they may be inflicting on the national game.”

BHIM SAIN JINDAL, Bathinda

("Terror on the Line", March 15). Till now West Bengal has not experienced any major terrorist activities or kidnapping. The authorities in the state must take steps to prevent any untoward incident.
LT-COL (RETD) RANJIT SINHA,
Kochi

War of Words

Your story on the Thilakan controversy in the small Malayalam film industry

towards one of their own, the crusty yet irreplaceable Thilakan.
VINOD KUMAR B.,
Bangalore

Corrigendum

In our March 22 issue of "High and Mighty Power List 2010", Suresh Kalmadi's age has been wrongly mentioned as 55. He is 65 years old. The error is regretted.
EDITOR

The Tax Squeeze

The average taxpayer in the clutches of the government is like an old tube of toothpaste in the hands of a thrifty housewife: the less he's got left, the harder he's squeezed. With rare exceptions, every year since the early '60s Parliament's 5 p.m. budget hour has pounded and twisted that well-used tube for every last bit it will yield. The government's budgets have been "an annual scourge"; comments tax expert Nani A. Palkhivala. In recent years, they have been marked by "reckless" taxation, adds member of Parliament and leading tax accountant NKP Salve. Indeed, the government's vice-like grip on the common man's hard-earned pay packet has come to resemble some life-squeezing tarantula, its tax-collecting limbs embedded in very nook and cranny of urban life. Back in the early '60s, when taxation was a more gentlemanly art, tax revenues were around 10 per cent of GNP. In 1978-79, the latest year for which data is available, the figure had leapt to almost twice as much. In the balmy days before the war with China, which jolted then finance minister Morarji Desai into a frenzy of taxation, about 1.5 million assesseees shelled out on an average Rs 1,240 each in income tax. **by Suman Dubey**

Readers are recommended to make appropriate enquiries before sending money, incurring expenses or entering into commitments in relation to any advertisement appearing in this publication. The India Today Group does not vouch for any claims made by the advertisers of products and services. The printer, publisher, editor-in-chief and the editor of the India Today Group publications shall not be held liable for any consequences in the event of such claims not being honoured by the advertisers.

E-MAIL YOUR LETTERS TO: letters.editor@intoday.com

FAX THEM TO: 011-23316180

OR LOG ON TO: www.indiatoday.in